DEPARTMENT MAGAZINE

Department of Nutrition and Dietetics

Alagappa University

Karaikudi-630003.

Department of Nutrition and Dietetics

"Nutrition Is The Only Remedy, That Can Be Full Recovery And Can Be used With Any Treatment, Remember, Food Is Our Best Medicine " *–Dr. Bernard Jensen*

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics was established in the year 2023. The Department offers a two year M.Sc., Degree Programme in Nutrition and Dietetics from the academic year 2023 - 2024. Our work focuses towards nurturing the students in solving the nutritional issues and setbacks faced by the community to forge a society with fitness and finesse. The postgraduate programme in Nutrition and Dietetics includes the complete study of basic components of foods; their nutrients chemistry and metabolism; technology involved in food processing and preservation; food safety; functional food, meal planning, quantity food production and therapeutic dietary modifications with a focus on human health and well-being. The department is making concerted efforts to achieve the national goal of "Healthy diet going affordable to all" through its continuous societal outreach activities in the rural areas serving the women and children, there by realizing the vision of our esteemed organization. Since its inception, the department has directed its activities towards development of the community to shape the prospective academicians, administrators, researchers, entrepreneurs and health conscious citizens.

Career Prospects

- Nutritionist & Diet consultant in fitness centres
- Public health officers
- Clinical Dietitian
- Sports Nutritionist
- Nutrition and Dietitian in food service establishments
- Nutritionist in health clinics and food industries
- Employed in the arena of planning, production, quality control and management of food processing Industries and Institutions.
- Involved in the production of drugs, food stuffs, cosmetics and other value-added products.

VISION

1. Prepare graduates to succeed in the transformation of human health status through better nutrition and community service.

MISSION

1. To offer a professional edge to the students by providing widening horizons and accommodating them in the discipline of Nutrition and Dietetics.
2. To prepare the interns to be competent enough and foster a commitment to ongoing development of their hands on practice skills.
3. To apply scientific thinking and ethical reasoning in the analysis, synthesis and evaluation of knowledge within the discipline of Food Science, Nutritional Science and Dietetics.

ACTIVITIES CONDUCTED / ORGANIZED BY THE DEPARTMENT OF NUTRITION AND DIETETICS

Induction Programme - 03-08-2023

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University has organized the Induction Programme on 3rd August, 2023. Dr. P. Rameshthangam, Programme Co-ordinator, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University welcomed the gathering and pointed out the importance Induction Programme. Senior Professor Dr.C.Sekar, Syndicate Member, Head-Department of Bioelectronics and Biosensor Inaugurated the function. Dr.P.Prabakaran. Teaching Assistant, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics proposed a vote of thanks.

Anti-Drug Abuse Pledge-11.08.2023

The International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking, or World Drug Day, is marked on 26 June every year to strengthen action and cooperation in achieving a world free of drug abuse. In this regard, the Department of Nutrition and Dietetics was taken a pledge on Anti-drug abuse on 11.08.2023

Sadbhavana Day Pledge- 18.08.2023

The aim of **sadbhavana** is to encourage peace, national integration and communal harmony among all religions. In this regard, the Department of Nutrition and Dietetics was taken a Sadbhavana day pledge on 18.08.2023.

M.Sc., Fresher's Day – 01.09.2023

University life will give you much more than just a degree-get ready for the all adventure.

The purpose of Fresher's Day party is to welcome new students in a friendly atmosphere and to encourage their creative impulses to boost their confidence. Dr.P.Rameshthangam, Associate Professor & Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, presided over the function. It was followed by words of blessings from all dignitaries to the fresher's.

National Nutrition Week -2023

"Nutrition isn't just about eating, it's about learning to live." - Patricia Compton

In India, National Nutrition Week is observed every year from 1st to 7th of September across the country in order to raise awareness about the importance of nutrition for health and well–being. The theme of the National Nutrition Week for the year 2023 is '**Healthy Diet Gawing Affordable for All'**. In this regard, the Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University celebrated National Nutrition Week on 1st September, 2023. Dr. P. Rameshthangam, Associate Professor & Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, welcomed the gathering and pointed out the significance of the nutrition week celebration and highlighted the importance of proper nutrition in maintaining health, preventing diseases and improving the overall quality of life. Faculties and PG students from science departments were participated in the Program.

Swachhata Pakhwada– 06.09.2023

Alagappa University has announced the Swachhata Pakhwada programme on 1st -15th September 2023. The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University organized Swachhata Pakhwada programme on 6th September 2023 at Alagappa Alumni Park. The theme of the programme on **"Swachhata Nutritional Food for Good Health"**. Dr. J. Jeyakanthan, Senior Professor, Dean- Faculty of Science inaugurated the function and distributed healthy food to the public people in Alagappa Alumni Park prepared by M.Sc Nutrition and Dietetics students. Dr. S. Thambidurai, Professor, Department of Industrial Chemistry, SwachhataProgramme Co-ordinator & Dr. P. Rameshthangam, Associate Professor & Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, created awareness about healthy diet to public. I year M.Sc-Nutrition and Dietetics students made a food stall and sold healthy nutritional food to the public people.

AUCR 90.8- "National Nutrition Week 2023" Special Program

Dr.P.Rameshthangam Associate professor & Head i/c of the department of Nutrition and Dietetics has given special speech on National Nutritional Week 2023 on 01.09.2023, K.Azhagurani, G. Biruntha I year M.Sc- Nutrition and Dietetics students gave Nutritional awareness through radio talk on 08.09.2023 on AUCR 90.8

Radio link : https://open.spotify.com/episode/24og78Gh0tNuKhl2rKRaih?si=S-oNJmogTLuMvCjft0zE4w

Radiolink: https://open.spotify.com/episode/4UadMuIRxtgqWAP3FfldsA?si=yCTsAM0TTJe8NeUbNYXp0g%0A

Lectures Delivered – 15.09.2023

As a resource person Dr.P.Rameshthangam, Associate Professor and Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University has delivered a special Lecture on **National Nutrition Week 2023** at Seethalakshmi Achi College for Women on 15th September 2023. Nearly 120 students and staff members were attended the programme.

As a resource person Mrs.R.Ramya, Teaching Assistant, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University delivered a special lecture on **Poshan Maa- Nutrition and Health and Nutritional deficiencies** at Child Development Project Office, Kallal block, Sivagangai(Dt) on 16thSeptember, 2023. Nearly 50 pregnant women and lactating mothers were benefited by this programme.

We have to reboot ourselves by switching to Organics and Millets - Krishna Byre Gowda, Agriculture Minister.

One day Workshop on Semi-Auto Chemistry Analyzer – 09.10.2023

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University has organized the one day Workshop on Semi -Auto Chemistry Analyzer on 9th October, 2023. Dr. P. Rameshthangam, Associate Professor & Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University welcomed the gathering and pointed out the significance of Semi – Auto Chemistry analyzer and highlighted the important uses of Semi-Auto Chemistry analyzer. Dr.H.Gurumallesh Prabu,Director, CDOE, Alagappa University has felicitate the programme. Mr.M.Akash and Mr.K.Dhanapalan, ATHENESE-DX PVT LTD, Chennai acted as a resource person and gave hands on training on Semi-Auto chemistry analyzer to the PG students. Dr.P.Prabakaran. Teaching Assistant, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics proposed a vote of thanks. Nearly 30 students of I M.Sc-Nutrition and Dietetics, 60 students of CDOE II M.Sc – Home Science – Nutrition and Dietetics benefited this programme.

Ayudha Pooja Celebration – 20.10.2023

Department of Nutrition and Dietetics has celebrated the Ayudha Pooja on 20.10.2023 at 1.30pm.

Integrity Pledge - 30.10.2023

Every citizen should be vigilant and commit to highest standards of honesty and integrity at all times and support the fight against corruption. In this regard, the Department of Nutrition and Dietetics was taken a pledge on integrity pledge on 30.10.2023.

Millet Food Festival – 11.12.2023

International Year of Millets– 2023 (IYoM 2023)

The year 2023 has been declared by the United Nations as the International Year of the Millet, following a proposal by India, which wants to position itself as a global hub for millet. To create domestic and global demand and to provide nutritional food to the people, the Government of India proposed to the United Nations to declare 2023 as the International Year of Millets (IYoM-2023).

In this regarding various Governmental and non-governmental institutions and organizations are celebrating the International year of Millets-2023 throughout the year. In Sivaganga district IYoM-2023 was celebrated as "Millet Food Festival – 2023 " organized by Sivaganga collectorate on the 11th December 2023 (Monday). The programme was presided by Mrs.Asha Ajith, IAS, District collector of Sivaganga. During the day, various events, exhibitions and competitions were arranged for the school & college students. Department Of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University Staffs and students were also participated in that programme and exhibit their prepared recipes in a creative way. Various officers, students and public people were observed and tasted our recipes and gave the positive feedback. The students were also received certificates from Mr.Mohanachadran, Deputy collector and Revenue officer, Sivanganga District for their participation. Dr.P.Rameshthangam, Asscoiate Professor & Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics thank the Sivaganga Collector and other officials for their support to participate in the Millet food festival.

Lectures Delivered -16.12.2023

Dr.P.Rameshthangam, Associate Professor and Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University acted as a resource person and delivered special lecture on **Refresher Course in Botany,** Organized by UGC - Malaviya Mission Teacher Training Centre, Madurai Kamaraj University,Madurai on 16th December, 2023.

Special Lecture – 19.12.2023

NUTRITION AND ENHANCED SPORTS PERFORMANCE

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics arranged a Special Lecture on "Nutrition and Enhanced Sports Performance" on 19th December, 2023. Dr.P.Rameshthangam, Asscoiate Professor & Head i/c, Presided over the function. Dr.P.Kaleeswaran, Professor, Alagappa University College of Physical Education Science, Alagappa University delivered a Special Lecture on the impact of sports nutrition on Physical and Mental health well-being. He spoke on job opportunities in the Sports Nutritionist sector. Dr.L.Gomathirajashyamala, Green house Co-Ordinator, Teaching Assistant, proposed a vote of thanks.

Pongal Celebration – 12.01.2024

Pongal is a multi-day Hindu harvest festival celebrated by Tamils. It is observed in the month of Thai according to the Tamil solar calendar and usually falls on 14 or 15 January and hence is also referred to as Thai Pongal. In this regard, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics has celebrated the Thai Pongal on 12.01.2024

Voter's Pledge - 24.01.2024

In order to encourage more young voters to take part in the political process, Government of India has decided to celebrate January 25 every year as "National Voters' Day". In this regard, the Department of Nutrition and Dietetics was taken a pledge on Voter's day pledge on 24.01.2023.

Untouchability Pledge-30.01.2024

Abolition of untouchability means that no one can prevent Dalits from educating themselves, entering temples, using public facilities etc. It also means that it is wrong to practise untouchability and that this practice will not be tolerated by a democratic government. In this regard, the Department of Nutrition and Dietetics took the Untouchability pledge on 24.01.2023

One-Day Workshop on Food Adulteration and its Impact on Health

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University has organized the One-day Workshop on Food Adulteration and its Impact on Health on 30th January 2024. Dr. P. Rameshthangam, Associate Professor & Head i/c, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University welcomed the gathering and pointed out the importance and effect of food adulteration. Mr. R. Thiyagarajan, Food Safety Officer, Sakottai & Kannakudi Block, Sivagangai District, Tamilnadu acted as a resource person and gave

lectures and hands-on training on Food Adulteration such as jaggery, tea powder, honey, coriander, turmeric & red chilli powder, pepper and also highlighted the Impact on Health to PG students. Mrs. R. Ramya, Orange House Co-Ordinator, Teaching Assistant, Department of Nutrition and Dietetics proposed a vote of thanks. Nearly 30 students of I M.Sc-Nutrition and Dietetics, benefited from this program.

Industrial Visit – 16.02.2024

National Institute of Food Technology, Entrepreneurship and Management, Thanjavur (NIFTEM – T)

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics, Alagappa University, Karaikudi has organized the Industrial Visit for M.Sc – Nutrition and Dietetics and visited The **National Institute of Food Technology, Entrepreneurship, and Management, Thanjavur (NIFTEM – T)** to understand the practical knowledge about Food processing, food packaging and Entrepreneurship development on 16.02.2024. Mr.M.Thirumoorthy, Senior Research Fellow, Department of Food Business Management and Entrepreneurship Development, welcomed the gatherings and highlighted the importance of food products in the Incubation centre. He has explained all the machineries and equipments such as - Double Screw Extruder, Radio Frequency Sterilizer (Bacteria Removal), Solar Drier, 3 Pilot Plant (Fruit Beverage, Ice Cream, Virgin Coconut Oil), Cabinate Air Tray Drier, Flaking Machine (Cornflakes), Onion Stem Cutter, Cryogenic Grinder (Masala Powder), Soya Cow Plant (Soy Milk), Spray Drier (Milk Powder), Freeze Drier (Moisture Removal), Ribbon Blender (Masala Blending), Sterilizing Machine, UruliRoaster (Rava), Pasta Making Machine, Gum Extruder, Compressed Candy Making Machine, Chocolate Branch and Bar Making Line.

Mrs.J.Bharathi, Project Assistant, Centre of Excellence for grain science, explained about the paddy and millet processing (Paddy Cleaner, Paddy Separator, Bran Remover, and ShinePolisher) equipment. She also highlighted the millets encompass a diverse group of cereals including pearl, foxtail, barnyard, little, finger, and sorghum having highly nutritional value. Miss. N.Thara, Research scholar from Food Engineering Lab highlighted the nutrient analysis of various grain products. She also explained the Rheometer (Viscosity), Water Activity Meter, Viscometer, Colour Flex Meter, Microwave Dryer and Textural Analyser.

Mr.Sriram Marimuthu, Senior Research Fellow, Department of Food Packaging Testing Laboratory has explained the different materials used in food packaging-Cola-aluminum cans, Brooke 3 bond roses - foil pouch, Milky mist toned milk - high density polyethylene, Toast tea rusk - PE, PP, BOPP materials, India Gate Basmati Rice - Plastic Bag, Teady bear gummies - polypropylene plastic, Coconut milk - laminated carton packages, Vakulaa Jain Sambar - Plastic Bag. All the teaching staffs and students of Department of Nutrition and Dietetics were benefited by gaining the industrial exposure from NIFTEM-T.

INDUSTRIAL VISIT to NIFTEM – T

Special Lecture -27.02.2024

APPLICATION OF NANOPARTICLES IN FOOD MICROBIOLOGY

The Department of Nutrition and Dietetics arranged a Special Lecture on "Application of Nanoparticles in Food Microbiology" on 27th February, 2024. Dr.P.Rameshthangam, Asscoiate Professor & Head i/c, Presided over the function. Dr.V.Shanmugaiah, Assistant Professor, Department of Microbial Technology, Madurai Kamaraj University, Madurai delivered a Special Lecture on microbial activity for food particles. He also highlighted the degradative changes produced by microorganisms, such as putrefaction, fermentation, and rancidity. Dr.P.Prabakaran, White house Co-ordinator, Teaching Assistant, proposed a vote of thanks.

National Science Day Celebration – 28.02.2024

National Science Day is celebrated every year on 28 February to mark the discovery of the 'Raman Effect' by Sir C.V. Raman on 28 February 1928. The "National Science Day-2024", under the theme "Indigenous Technology for Viksit Bharat". In this connection Department of Nutrition and Dietetics has organized the National Science Day under the theme of "Diversion of diet with Millets.

I M.Sc- Nutrition and Dietetics students prepared the millet based food products such as Barnyard millet cutlet, Barnyard millet thattai, Kodo millet Gulabjamun, Foxtail millet Poli, Pearl millet cookies, Foxtail millet Laddu, Kodo millet porridge, Foxtail millet pancake, Sorghum millet paniyaram, Kodo millet murukku and also demonstrated the food adulteration. They were exhibited in the Science Day celebration. There are many different school students, college students, teachers, and faculty members saw the Science Day exhibition.

MILLET MAP OF INDIA